

CHAPTER FIVE

WINTER KILLS

Steve Rogers' past collides with his present when the masked operative known as the Winter Soldier ambushes the car in which Steve, Sam, and Natasha are traveling. S.H.I.E.L.D. Agent Jasper Sitwell, in the back seat, is brutally plucked from their midst by an unseen hand. The three heroes are taken by surprise, unable to see their assailant from within the car's claustrophobic confines; they are then separated in the ensuing strike.

Black Widow takes on the man beneath the mask first. "The battle on the roadway is a great scene," Concept Artist Rodney Fuentebella says. "I wanted the chaos and destruction to encircle Black Widow and Winter Soldier."

Moments later, Captain America joins the fray. Then suddenly—shockingly—his rendezvous with the past is revealed. The man out of time is faced with the horror of truth.

But he is not alone.

"With Winter Soldier, Directors Joe and Anthony Russo really wanted a strong icon that was just scary. It was like they wanted to create the next Darth Vader or Boba Fett," Head of Visual Development Ryan Meinerding says. "And they talked about it with such passion that it was kind of intimidating to work on, because I never went into a meeting thinking, 'Oh yeah, I've nailed the next Boba Fett.' They really wanted Winter Soldier to be a threat to Cap, and to be dangerous and resonate and stay in people's minds like those villains have."